

PROCEEDINGS OF THE GENERAL GRAND CHAPTER ROYAL ARCH MASONS INTERNATIONAL
Pages 87- 89 [1957]
50th Triennial Convocation of the General Grand Chapter Royal Arch Masons, International
October 1-3, 1957.

REPORT OF COMMITTEE ON
ROYAL ARCH DAY OBSERVANCE

Companion Herbert T. Leyland, P.G.H.P., Chairman, presented the report of the Committee on Royal Arch Day Observance, as follows, which was adopted:

To the General Grand Chapter of Royal Arch Masons:

Shortly after the close of the General Grand Chapter Convocation at Asheville, the General Grand High Priest issued a bulletin appointing, in each of the jurisdictions affiliated with General Grand Chapter, a special Committee to foster the observance of Religious Affirmation Day. The Committee consisted of the Grand High Priest, Grand King and Grand Scribe, or Grand 1st, 2nd and 3rd principals in office January 1, 1955; this Committee to serve for the Triennium.

The author of this report was appointed as General Chairman of the R. A. Day Project and requested by our General Grand High Priest to communicate with the Chairmen of the various jurisdictions. The purpose of selecting a General Chairman was to furnish a clearing house for the various Chairmen to exchange plans and information relative to the observance of the Day; various types of services, suggestions as to possible programs, attendance arrangements, etc.

The Day was designated as the Sunday nearest October 24th, that date being selected because of its special significance to General Grand Chapter. The purpose of R. A. Day was well stated by our General Grand High Priest in his Proclamation of June 15, 1955, that "All R.A.M., wherever dispersed, should annually proclaim their belief in the fundamental tenets of our Fraternity by a public observance of a day set apart as Religious Affirmation Day ... "

Pursuant to the wishes of the General Grand High Priest, the General Chairman, early in 1955 addressed a letter to the Chairman of each jurisdiction. The letter invited the attention of the Chairman to the project and its importance ; explained the function of the General Chairman and requested information as to the plans of the jurisdiction for the observance of R. A. Day in 1955. Prompt responses were received from some 20 jurisdictions indicating a desire to cooperate in observing R. A. Day and asking information on how to proceed. A considerable amount of correspondence resulted which, it is hoped, was helpful to the various Chairmen and Committees. The General Chairman secured from the General Grand Secretary a copy of "Suggestions for Organizing R. A. Day" by Companion F. Alan Lane of Washington, had a supply of the same mimeographed and mailed out copies to all Companions asking information.

In June 1955, a second letter was sent to those Chairmen who had not responded earlier. Additional jurisdictions responded, advising of their plans for the 1955 observances.

In all, the Chairmen of 36 states and provinces informed the General Chairman of the plans for R. A. Day. After R. A. Day 1955 had passed, numerous reports were received, relating the services held to observe the Day. The General Chairman, under date of January 6, 1956, submitted a report to the General Grand High Priest summarizing the information received at Dayton.

In May 1956, the General Chairman addressed a letter to the Chairmen of all jurisdictions suggesting that it was time to begin planning for the celebration of the 1956 R. A. Day. The letter advised the Chairmen that the General Grand High Priest did not plan to issue a second proclamation and hence any jurisdiction wishing to do so might proceed without fear of duplication of effort in that respect. Several Grand High Priests thereafter issued Edicts and

Proclamations relating to R. A. Day. As in 1955 a considerable correspondence was carried on with Committee Chairmen. The purpose of R. A. Day was better understood, however, and the correspondence generally reflected a desire to carry on a program similar to that observed in 1955.

During the winter of 1956-7 the General Chairman received numerous letters from Committee Chairmen reporting on the services held in 1956. Several jurisdictions advised that the observance of R. A. Day had been made an annual event, either by law or custom. At least two jurisdictions responded with information about their 1956 observance, which did not report in 1955.

In June, 1957 the General Chairman communicated with all jurisdictions, inquiring about the 1957 observance of R. A. Day. The replies received to date indicate a continuing interest in the observance of R. A. Day. It is not possible to go further, in this report, than to say that a large number of the state and province Grand Chapters affiliated with General Grand Chapter will hold a third annual celebration of R. A. Day in October of this year. The General Chairman is of the opinion that much good was accomplished by the R. A. Day project and that the results will be felt, in Capitular Masonry, for some years to come.

Fraternally submitted,
Herbert T. Leyland
General Chairman

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